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JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

‘A beautiful prison’

Newly released but still facing deportation, Mahdawi returns to his sanctuary in Vermont

By Paul Heintz

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

WEST FAIRLEE, Vt. — When he reached the ridgeline above his property, Mohsen Mahdawi marveled at the miles of rolling hills in the distance, a late-afternoon sun illuminating the budding trees in the valley before him.

“This feels like freedom, you know?,” he said, his left arm sweeping across the landscape, palm open as if to hold it all in his hand. “You look at the horizon and you see the clouds racing.”

That view had particular resonance for Mahdawi this week. One of several high-profile international students targeted for deportation by the Trump administration for protesting the Israel-Hamas war, Mah-

dawi was released from detention in a northern Vermont prison just a week ago. He has returned to what he calls his “sanctuary”: 21 acres of forestland off an unpaved road in the rural reaches of the upper Connecticut River Valley. The roof of a tiny cabin he’d built was just visible through the trees below.

“It’s amazing,” he said of the view, grinning.

A Columbia University student who grew up in the occupied West Bank, the 34-year-old Mahdawi was detained in April after being summoned to a federal immigration office in Vermont for what was supposed to be his final test to become a US citizen.

MAHDAWI, Page A15

BACK HOME



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Tufts PhD student Rümeysa Öztürk arrived in Massachusetts Saturday after being released from ICE detention. **B1.**

A town feels cuts from all directions

Everyone in this rural area has a DOGE story

By Tal Kopan

GLOBE STAFF

ALBRIGHT, W.Va. — A music and art festival nestled in an Appalachian river valley wouldn’t immediately seem like a place where President Trump’s Department of Government Efficiency would be top of mind.

But outdoorsy locals at the annual Cheat River Festival last weekend were indeed ruminating on the many ways the long arm of Washington has disrupted life in these verdant woods.

Sitting in lawn chairs with friends listening to a folk band was a Forest Service employee who’s lost so many colleagues to layoffs and buyouts that he worries about the cascading effects of the cuts on local communities and forests. An artist selling wood work inlaid with stone lost a grant to help grow the whitewater rafting business she owns with her husband.

Seeking refuge from the intermittent sun and showers under the communal tent were PhD students in natural resources from nearby West Virginia University, in danger of losing funding and feeling their longtime dream of ultimately working in federal jobs was no longer viable.

There were also retired longtime Office of Surface Mining workers worrying about govern-

DOGE, Page A12

‘If you treat that 90-year-old as if they’re 90 ... you might withhold more intensive treatment.’

DR. RAY MAK, *Brigham and Women’s Hospital*

‘As old as you look’ may soon be a diagnosis, too

AI rates survival odds by facial features

By Kay Lazar

GLOBE STAFF

Those bags under your eyes may be more telling than you realize.

The human face holds intriguing clues about how much a person has aged from the inside out, known as a person’s biological age, according to new research from scientists at Mass General Brigham.

The researchers found that a simple photo, analyzed by a computer trained to detect small, subtle differences in facial features, such as the amount of muscle around a person’s temples, can give doctors a more accurate assessment of a patient’s health; specifically, to determine if that patient is strong enough to endure more aggressive treatment.

The new computer tool, called FaceAge, was designed to pinpoint a person’s biological age and to predict survival outcomes for patients with cancer. While it has yet to be tested on patients, the scientists believe it could eventually help with other treatment decisions, such as whether someone is robust enough for a hip replacement.

The new research, published Thursday in *Lancet Digital Health*, was born out of a cancer specialist’s frustration at not having objective tools to help discern which patients are strong enough to withstand aggressive chemotherapy and radiation treatments, especially older patients.

FACE, Page A16

A death, and signs of earlier violence missed

Luck, leniency on prior abuse benefited suspect

By Tricia L. Nadolny, Joey Flechas, and Elizabeth Koh

GLOBE STAFF

NEW BEDFORD — Tyler Baglini burst into the emergency room of St. Luke’s Hospital in September with a stained kitchen knife in his hand and an urgent message: He needed to report a murder. Police quickly handcuffed him to a hospital bed, flecks of blood still on his face.

He said his girlfriend, Kerri Fidalgo, 31, had been stabbed. Doctors pronounced her dead shortly afterward in a room nearby.

Almost immediately, all signs pointed to Baglini: Detectives found his ID in Fidalgo’s home and threatening messages from him on her cellphone, including a text with a photo of a knife.

News of Baglini’s arrest spread quickly through Bristol County, where others had watched his drug use and erratic behavior spin out of control. Most notably, Baglini’s ex-wife, Brittany Grimes, had been waiting five years for him to stand trial in Rhode Island on charges of choking and raping her.

Grimes was already frustrated with the criminal justice system’s handling of her ex-husband. As she reflected on his lengthy history of crimes, each one seemed like a warning sign.

VIOLENCE, Page A17

A reporter suspected she was having a miscarriage. A broken health care system made it so much worse. **Globe Magazine.**

The house with the white picket fence is not for everyone,

because of money or lifestyle. **Address, H1.**

Top economic officials from the United States and China planned a second day of trade talks for Sunday. **A11.**

NET RESULTS



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

The Celtics beat the Knicks, 115-93, after two losses to start the Eastern Conference semifinal series. Al Horford (above) had 15 points and 8 rebounds. **Sports, C1.**

The budding system

Sunday: Sunny, warm. High: 66-71. Low: 46-51.
Monday: Much the same. High: 70-75. Low: 54-59.
Complete report, **A24.**
Deaths, **A18-23.**

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